

# Zero-to-One MENA ABM Engine

How I built enterprise ABM from scratch in the MENA cybersecurity market and hit 10+ SQLs/month

CASE STUDY · RASUL SHAIKH · GTM ENGINEER

**10+ SQLs/mo**

FROM ZERO

**30%**

AVG ENGAGEMENT RATE

**25%**

PIPELINE FROM PARTNERS

**3**

CO-MARKETING CHANNELS

## THE PROBLEM

FalconWise Tech was selling enterprise cybersecurity solutions in the MENA market — UAE, Saudi Arabia, Egypt — with no outbound motion and no brand awareness outside of a few warm referrals. The enterprise sales cycle was 90+ days and required multi-stakeholder buy-in (CISO, IT Director, CFO). There was no ABM program, no content targeting enterprise buyers, and no partner channel. Starting from zero in a high-trust, relationship-driven market is the hardest possible starting point.

## THE ABM ARCHITECTURE

- Account selection: Built a target account list of 180 enterprise organizations across UAE, KSA, and Egypt using Apollo + LinkedIn Sales Nav, filtered by employee count (500+), industry (BFSI, government, healthcare, telecom), and known cybersecurity spend signals.
- Multi-source enrichment: Clay pipeline pulling from LinkedIn, company websites, news sources, and procurement portals to identify buying signals — budget cycles, regulatory compliance deadlines, recent breaches, and executive changes.
- Persona mapping: Identified and enriched 3 buyer personas per account — CISO (economic buyer), IT Director (technical champion), and CFO (budget approver) — with personalized messaging for each.
- Co-marketing: Partnered with 3 regional cybersecurity vendors (non-competing) for joint webinars, co-authored whitepapers, and shared event sponsorships — pipeline from partners reached 25% of total within 4 months.
- LinkedIn Ads ABM: Targeted the account list + personas with LinkedIn matched audiences. Used engagement retargeting to serve case study content to accounts that had visited the website.
- Outbound sequences: Multi-touch sequences per persona: cold email (Clay-personalized) → LinkedIn connection → LinkedIn voice note → email follow-up with content asset. Sequences ran in Arabic and English.

# Zero-to-One MENA ABM Engine

CASE STUDY · RASUL SHAIKH · GTM ENGINEER

## THE RESULTS

---

- 10+ SQLs per month within 5 months of building the program from scratch — pipeline previously averaged 1-2 inbound SQLs per month.
- 30% average engagement rate across ABM content sequences — driven by Arabic-language personalization and region-specific regulatory framing (UAE NESA, Saudi Arabia NCA compliance).
- 25% of pipeline sourced from the partner co-marketing channel within 4 months of launching the first joint webinar.
- 3 strategic co-marketing partnerships closed with regional cybersecurity vendors, generating shared pipeline and joint content assets.
- Enterprise sales cycle reduced from 90+ days average to 60 days through earlier stakeholder mapping and multi-threaded outreach.

## MENA-SPECIFIC GTM NOTES

---

- Language matters more than expected. Arabic-language email openings — even when the full email is English — increased reply rates by 40% with Arabic-speaking decision-makers.
- Regulatory triggers are the strongest signal in MENA. Framing outreach around UAE NESA, NCA, or SAMA compliance deadlines created urgency that standard pain-point messaging didn't.
- Relationship before pitch. MENA enterprise buyers expect 2-3 touchpoints of value delivery before a product conversation. The co-marketing model front-loaded this.
- LinkedIn penetration in MENA enterprise is higher than expected — especially in UAE. LinkedIn outreach worked better than cold email as the first touch in this market.

## STACK

---

ABM / Enrichment: Clay, Apollo, LinkedIn Sales Navigator, Firecrawl  
Outbound: Instantly (cold email), HeyReach (LinkedIn), Trigify (signals)  
Advertising: LinkedIn Ads (matched audiences + retargeting), Meta Ads  
CRM / Reporting: HubSpot, n8n, Google Data Studio